



City Council Meeting

December 1, 2025

6:00 p.m.

Cadillac Municipal Complex

Council Chambers

200 N. Lake St.

Cadillac, MI 49601



December 1, 2025 City Council Meeting Agenda
6 p.m. at City Hall - 200 N. Lake St. – Cadillac, MI 49601

We support each other in serving our community

CALL TO ORDER
PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE
ROLL CALL

I. APPROVAL OF AGENDA

II. PUBLIC COMMENTS

This opportunity for public comment provides the public with a chance to make a statement regarding any subject matter. Public comment is not an opportunity to necessarily ask questions or converse with City Staff, Council Members or other meeting attendees. Contact information for Council and staff is available on our website, www.cadillac-mi.net, or can be obtained by calling (231) 775-0181. Comment time is limited to 3-minutes, and unused time may not be yielded back or given to someone else to use.

III. PFAS UPDATE

IV. CONSENT AGENDA

All items listed on the consent agenda are considered routine and will be enacted by one motion with roll call vote. There will be no separate discussion of these items unless a Council Member so requests it, in which event the items will be removed from the consent agenda and discussed separately.

- A. Minutes from the regular meeting held on November 17, 2025
Support Document IV-A

V. COMMUNITY SPOTLIGHT

- A. Cadillac Salvation Army

VI. PROCLAMATION

- A. Water and Wastewater Professionals Workforce Week
Support Document VI-A

Cadillac City Council Agenda

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VII. MINUTES AND REPORTS OF BOARDS AND COMMISSIONS

A. Cadillac West Corridor Improvement Authority Support Document VII-A

VIII. PUBLIC COMMENTS

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IX. GOOD OF THE ORDER

X. ADJOURNMENT

Core Values (R.I.T.E.)

Respect

Integrity

Trust

Excellence

Guiding Behaviors

We support each other in serving our community

We communicate openly, honestly, respectfully, and directly

We are fully present

We are all accountable

We trust and assume goodness in intentions

We are continuous learners

CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

November 17, 2025

Cadillac City Hall - 200 N. Lake St. - Cadillac, Michigan 49601

CALL TO ORDER

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Schippers at approximately 6:00 pm.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

ROLL CALL

Council Present: Elenbaas, Hopkins, Engels, French, Mayor Schippers

Council Absent: None

Staff Present: Peccia, Dietlin, Waldo, Ottjepka, Homier, Wasson

ANNOUNCEMENT

Mayor Schippers read the following prepared statement:

Before we begin tonight's meeting, I want to acknowledge public concern regarding the status of the partial-term Council seats connected to the recent election and let you know that the Council has received and reviewed a confidential legal opinion on this matter.

Because of the level of public interest, and because tonight's published agenda does not include some of our normal procedural items, Council may wish to consider amending the agenda now at the start of the meeting. This could include adding the routine approval of the agenda and the approval of minutes, as well as determining whether Council wants to address the election-related issue this evening. Of course, those decisions are entirely up to the Council as a whole.

I would like to thank everyone in attendance and the general public-- in advance-- for your patience-- as we work through this carefully and responsibly.

Now, before we move forward, I will open the floor for any motions regarding the agenda.

Engels noted that while he appreciates the agenda that the City Manager prepared, he believes we need to include the routine items such as approval of agenda and minutes, and we need to discuss the election and Charter issues tonight. He pointed to a copy of correspondence he had sent to Council prior to the meeting (see attachment).

2025-265 Amend agenda.

Motion was made by Engels and supported by Elenbaas to amend the agenda as follows:

- Add approval of the agenda immediately after the Announcement
- Add approval of the minutes from the last October meeting immediately following the approval of the agenda
- Add an Item C under the City Manager's Report concerning the 2025 November Election
- Add a new item titled "Council discussion about Charter Section 3.6"

Engels stated he believes these additions to the agenda will ensure that we maintain our normal procedures and fulfill our responsibility to discuss the Charter issue and the Election issue.

Motion unanimously approved.

2025-266 Approve agenda as amended.

Motion was made by Elenbaas and supported by Engels to approve the agenda as amended.

Motion unanimously approved.

2025-267 Approve minutes from meeting held on October 20, 2025.

Motion was made by Engels and supported by Elenbaas to approve the minutes from the October 20, 2025 meeting.

Motion unanimously approved.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Bill Barnett stated the City violated the Charter by not holding a required special election for the three appointees. He noted there needs to be a full and complete investigation conducted by a neutral third party.

Michelle Trivieri congratulated David Powell for winning the election and all the candidates that ran for office in this political climate. She noted City Council Members are busy all of the time and she has a lot of respect for them.

Carla Moore asked why Ms. French and Mr. Hopkins are seated on Council but not David Powell since all three won the election. She encouraged Council to put the citizens first.

Art Stevens commented on previous elections that were held when Council Members were appointed. He noted appointments are made for a length of time.

Randy Lindell discussed the importance of having a walkable community in the winter by having the sidewalks plowed. He stated he appreciates the Street Department for cleaning up the leaves in the streets and encouraged Council not to adjust ordinances and the Charter.

PFAS UPDATE

Jeff Dietlin, Director of Utilities, noted the State of Michigan completed the comparative PFAS study of the three labs and basically all three labs had similar good results. He noted we are doing our quarterly sampling in the LDFA area this week and they are going to be conducting PFAS testing on those samples, which is something new that the EPA is requiring.

Dietlin played a video titled "Cadillac's Response to Environmental Challenges". The video is available on the City's website.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

A. Joint Planning and Development Meeting

Peccia noted the annual Joint Planning and Development Meeting has been scheduled for January 26, 2026 at 6:00 PM during the regularly scheduled Planning Commission meeting. He stated we are looking for a couple of volunteers from City Council to attend this meeting.

Engels noted he is on the Board of Review and is not allowed to serve on any other boards or commissions. He asked if this would be just an advisory role for this meeting.

Peccia stated it's an official meeting between the Joint Planning Commission and the Planning Commission and then there will be representatives from other boards and commissions in attendance.

Engels noted the Mayor is on the Planning Commission so he assumes the Mayor will attend the meeting. He stated if being on the Board of Review doesn't prohibit it, he would be willing to attend.

Peccia noted it can be addressed again in January.

B. 2nd Annual Cadillac West Christmas Tree Lighting

Peccia noted the Cadillac West Corridor is holding the 2nd Annual Christmas Tree Lighting at 4:00 pm on Saturday, November 29, 2025 at the Point West Mall. He stated the event will include music, crafts, activities and Santa Claus. He noted they wanted to invite all of City Council to attend.

Peccia noted the downtown tree lighting will be held on the Friday after Thanksgiving.

C. November 2025 Election

Peccia apologized for the administrative error that occurred regarding the November 2025 Election. He noted for any confusion, disruption, concerns, or issues that this may have caused, please note there is no cover-up and no conspiracy. He added there are no efforts underway to be noncompliant with our Charter. He stated the partial term ballot was not part of the November 2025 Election, nor were any petitions received and no one reached out to us. He noted our organization strives for excellence in everything we do and we're all very upset and quite embarrassed that we simply did not catch the need for a partial term ballot prior to the July filing deadline. He stated it was a complete oversight that was likely caused due to the unique circumstances, specifically, the Council positions filled by appointments were the same Council positions that were terming out and automatically going to be on the November ballot. He noted no one thought to have them listed twice for a partial term lasting through the balance of November and December. He stated in the past, prior Council vacancies occurred mid-term and a partial term ballot was made available without any issues.

Peccia noted if another vacancy occurs in the future for a seat that is automatically going to be on the November ballot because it is terming out, staff and everyone involved are very aware that a partial term spot will also need to be on the ballot and an oversight like this should never happen again.

Mayor Schippers stated it was mentioned that we should have done it in May or August. She noted in the past there were other things on the ballot, so it was the next election in which those seats were filled. She stated in her experience, we have never held an election just to fill those interim seats. She asked the City Attorney if we are required to call a special election or if it is to occur in the next election.

City Attorney Homier noted the Charter says it's the next ensuing citywide election. He stated he doesn't see anything in the Charter that required you to call a special election. He noted there is a timeframe under Section 3.6 which states that the election has to be at least 60 days after the vacancy occurs.

Engels noted his partial term election was held in November but there was a significant amount of time remaining, two years and several months, when he ran for his partial term seat.

Mayor Schippers noted the seats for both Council Member Hopkins (Ward 2) and Council Member French (Ward 4) were up for election in November and that has never occurred before.

NEW BUSINESS

A. Discussion regarding Section 3.6 of the Charter.

Engels noted he wants to start by clarifying and building upon the comments he shared with the newspaper. He stated there is a lot of confusion and misinformation and he knows that it isn't easy to understand the mistake that was made or how we should move forward. He noted he's trying his best to understand it and interpret the language of the Charter. He stated the statement he gave to the paper focused on one simple principle which is that the City Charter governs how Council vacancies are filled and the plain language of Section 3.6 says that once an appointment is made a Council Member shall continue to hold office until successor is elected and qualified.

Engels noted to address one of the issues brought up by Mr. Stevens, he wants to be clear that no motion made by Council can change the Charter. He stated if earlier in the year someone referred to an appointment lasting until November, or if a motion was worded in a way that suggested as much, those comments do not and cannot amend or override the City Charter. He noted the Charter determines the duration of an appointee's service and it says appointees continue to serve until a successor is elected and qualified.

Engels stated the Charter lists conditions for a vacancy such as a member missing four consecutive meetings or moving out of the City or the Ward. He noted that none of those conditions that the Charter says creates a vacancy occurred. He stated the Charter does not say that an appointed term ends if the City doesn't run an election. He noted if the Charter intended a missed partial term election creates a vacancy it would have said so in Section 3.6 when it lists the four other things that create a vacancy under the appointment section, but it doesn't. He stated nothing in the Charter says a missed partial term election creates a vacancy.

Engels noted the Charter states that an appointed member serves until a successor is elected for the remainder of the term and is qualified. He stated that it is an event not a date. He noted this means someone must be elected specifically for the remainder of the current term, not a whole new term, and then that person must be sworn in. He stated these two conditions were not met in this past election. He noted the remainder term seats were not on the ballot, no one filed to run, and no successor was elected or qualified for those few remaining weeks. He stated the idea that these seats automatically become vacant on an election day, whether the election day was November, August or March also has absolutely no basis in the Charter.

Engels referenced a comment made by Carla Moore about David Powell and noted the election for whole terms are governed under Section 8.7 not the same section as vacancies. He stated David Powell's term starts on January 1st and the section on appointments is continuity-based going forward. He noted it is not meant for someone to serve before their term starts and he thinks qualified also means that your term has begun. He stated if a term begins January 1st, you can't be qualified on a date before that time.

Engels stated he believes the Charter addresses the issues in the opposite way that some people are suggesting. He noted he thinks the Charter requires the appointed officials to continue serving because no successor was elected for the remainder of the term. He added he thinks the Charter language actually keeps these seats from being vacant and believes the appointed Council Members are obligated to continue serving and voting on Council.

Engels noted we heard from the City Manager about what happened and if not following the Charter procedure got us to where we are today, he fails to see how not following the Charter language again is going to make it any better. He stated the proposed solutions that he has heard sound fair, are appreciated, and are logical but none of them have any basis in the Charter language as he sees it. He noted that's why he voted the way he did tonight and why he pushed out his comments to the paper.

French stated as an appointee she feels badly that we are at this procedural misunderstanding of what is a truly lame duck session, but the goal is to maintain the spirit of the Charter which she feels that Council Member Engels more than adequately described. She noted she believes it's a fine gray line that we are all walking towards the best outcome for the situation. She stated this was nothing that anybody planned for and believed assumptions were made that the appointed seats went to the end of the year. She noted she thinks the best way forward is for Council to be gracious and do as little decision-making as possible but to continue to hold these meetings for the good of the public and to have opportunities to interact with staff and also to have educational or informative opportunities. She suggested that we have some spotlight sessions from various groups to make good use of our time together and allow us and the public to hear from community organizations that are doing good work within the City.

Engels stated the comment from Council Member French is very wise. He noted he doesn't want to move forward as if no mistake was made but believes everybody is obligated to continue serving and voting but that does not mean that we have to take up anything

significant for the rest of the year. He stated highlighting some community groups is a good idea. He noted when people vote for a candidate, they bring their own personality and flavor to the Council. He stated what Council Member French is saying about highlighting some of the organizations she's involved in that are important to her is the perfect way to start December if we can pull that together.

Peccia noted we are already working on it.

Mayor Schippers stated she thinks that moving forward means we need to move forward. She noted we do need to continue the work of the people for this interim period. She stated as she mentioned earlier, we have never had this kind of situation and so we are doing the best that we can mindfully. She noted we will not be doing any major votes, but it is important that the business of the City continue. She stated people can disagree with Council Member Engel's interpretation or with her interpretation of the Charter and that is okay. She noted in this position that we are in, we have to go with what we think is best for the community and not leave us with nothing until January.

Mayor Schippers noted she looks forward to David Powell's term beginning in January and what he will bring to Council. She stated she also looks forward to all of us learning a lot from this including staff. She noted who would have thought that we would have to have a ballot where you would have to vote twice for someone. She stated in her experience we have never held a separate election to fill an interim, we always went until the next election. She stated elections are very expensive and a lot of work, so we normally go to the next citywide election to fill those appointments which is what we did.

Mayor Schippers stated here we are in this kerfuffle with terms not starting until January 1st and that is absolutely in the Charter. She noted we need to go with this the best we can and continue to do the business of the community and the City with everybody's best interest at heart. She stated nobody was trying to slip anything through. She noted this election could have turned out completely differently if these candidates did not win their seats and we'd be having the same conversation but in a different context.

Mayor Schippers stated the fact that the City voted to retain these appointees tells her that they have confidence in these appointees to serve. She noted to have them step away until January 1st and then begin to serve again and put all of the business of the City on hold seems ludicrous to her. She stated since this is the outcome this is what she thinks we should do moving forward.

Elenbaas asked for an explanation of what it takes to change the City Charter.

Homier stated you must convene the Charter Commission who then make changes to the Charter and then the proposed changes are voted on by the people. He noted before it goes to the election it goes to the governor's office for approval and gets reviewed by the AG's office.

Engels asked if there is a mechanism for an amendment.

Homier stated you could propose an amendment to the Charter that would go on the ballot. He noted it first has to go to the AG's office, who serves as counsel to the governor's office, for review.

Engels summarized by stating it involves Council voting to support an idea, legal generating ballot language, the governor's office approving it and then the people of the City voting whether to approve or not approve it.

Engels stated if we wanted to have an amendment that says the next time there's a vacancy an election must occur within six months and if there is not an election scheduled then we do have to spend the money. He asked if that would be simpler.

Homier stated that is correct.

Mayor Schippers stated that is something to look at in January.

Engels noted if Council had decided after the 60 days were up after the appointments that we wanted to incur that expense we would have made a motion, got support, voted and then the City would have moved forward scheduling an election in April if we wanted.

Homier stated we probably couldn't do that because the election code was changed to require even special elections to occur on regular election days.

French stated she doesn't believe a change will be required. She noted going forward, this situation will never happen again even with the current language.

Schippers stated hopefully the City will outlive all of us so it's important to not just rely on institutional memory but codify it.

Engels noted he doesn't have a problem with the appointment process, but he didn't like when we had to pick a new Mayor. He stated we didn't like the idea and a lot of people in town struggled with the idea that the Mayor Pro Tem didn't automatically become Mayor and we were picking a Mayor.

Mayor Schippers noted as Mayor Pro Tem that surprised her as well.

Engels stated maybe in the future we do need to get feedback and see if there is any appetite for these amendments because he was definitely unhappy with that process. He noted he believes the Charter should say that the Mayor Pro Tem gets promoted for the remainder of the term. He stated there is no way that an elected Council Member who is appointed to Mayor should be counted as an appointed official.

MINUTES AND REPORTS OF BOARDS AND COMMISSIONS

A. Cadillac West Corridor Improvement Authority

B. Historic Districts Commission

C. Planning Commission

D. Zoning Board of Appeals

E. Cadillac-Clam Lake Joint Planning Commission

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Bill Barnett stated Council violated the Charter and he asked for an independent investigation and accountability.

Michelle Trivieri commented on the 1st Annual Tree Lighting Ceremony in Cadillac West last year and encouraged everyone to come this year.

Art Stevens stated this is a big issue because the appointments were made for a specific time period.

Mike Coy stated that he has heard many positive comments from various people about what has been going on in the City this year.

Bonnie Edwards asked if some of the Council seats are only occupied until November 4th why are they sitting with Council and not with the public.

GOOD OF THE ORDER

Engels stated he wanted to make a clarification on how the agenda comes together. He noted he did start out his remarks by saying he appreciates the agenda that the City Manager put together in consideration of all of the things going on out there. He stated he rejects that's how we should move forward doing business because the City Manager sets the agenda but it's up to Council to vote on it and run the meeting. He noted he didn't want to have a meeting where we didn't approve the agenda, approve the minutes, and have a substantive discussion about Section 3.6 and about the election errors. He stated to suggest that his rejection of the way the City Manager presented this agenda was part of a secret plan or improper is not true. He noted he wanted people to understand how the agenda is put together and the Council responds to it once they see it.

Mayor Schippers wished everyone a Happy Thanksgiving and asked people to be mindful and kind. She noted a lot of people are struggling and encouraged people to help where they can and be good neighbors.

ADJOURNMENT

Respectfully submitted,

Tiyi Schippers, Mayor

Sandra Wasson, City Clerk

Sandra Wasson

From: Marcus Peccia
Sent: Monday, November 17, 2025 1:06 PM
To: Homier, Michael; Laura J. Genovich; Sandra Wasson
Subject: RE: Information for Tonight's Meeting – Do Not Reply
Attachments: October 20, 2025 City Council Minutes.pdf

Good Afternoon Members of Council via BCC, Mike, Laura, and Sandi,

Attached is a copy of the draft Minutes from Council's last meeting that was held on October 20, 2025, not November 3. A copy of this correspondence, including the draft Minutes, will be printed out for everyone, and will be in the Minutes in next month's packet accordingly.

Best,

Marcus A. Peccia, City Manager
City of Cadillac
200 N. Lake Street
Cadillac, MI 49601
Direct: 231-779-7344
Email: mpeccia@cadillac-mi.net
[City Website](#)
[City Facebook Page](#)
[Cadillac Area Chamber of Commerce](#)
[Visit Greater Cadillac](#)

From: Robert Engels <rengels@Cadillac-MI.net>
Sent: Monday, November 17, 2025 11:43 AM
To: Marcus Peccia <mpeccia@cadillac-mi.net>; Homier, Michael <mhomier@fosterswift.com>; Laura J. Genovich <lgenovich@fosterswift.com>
Subject: Information for Tonight's Meeting – Do Not Reply

I wanted to let you guys know that I plan to make a motion after Roll Call and the Announcement, to amend the agenda to restore our normal order of business and allow for proper discussion of the election and the Charter issue.

Specifically, my motion will propose adding:

1. **Approval of the Agenda**
2. **Approval of the Minutes** from the November 3rd meeting
3. Under the City Manager's Report, a new Item C: **November 2025 Election**
4. A Council-led discussion item regarding **Section 3.6 of the Charter**, placed under New Council Business, after the City Manager's report.

I am sharing this for awareness only, so no one is surprised. **Please do not reply to this message.** For transparency, I have asked the City Manager to include this message in the public packet and provide the meeting minutes to the council.

-Councilmember Robert J. Engels-

CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

October 20, 2025

Cadillac City Hall - 200 N. Lake St. - Cadillac, Michigan 49601

CALL TO ORDER

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Schippers at approximately 6:00 pm.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

ROLL CALL

Council Present: Elenbaas, Hopkins, French, Mayor Schippers

Council Absent: Engels

Staff Present: Peccia, Roberts, Waldo, Homier (via Zoom), Wasson

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

2025-257 Approve agenda as amended.

Motion was made by Hopkins and supported by French to approve the agenda as amended to add a sign request from the First Presbyterian Church under the City Manager's Report.

Motion unanimously approved.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Art Stevens referred to the City Charter and questioned whether the terms of the City Council Members that were appointed end after the upcoming election or on December 31, 2025.

PFAS UPDATE

Peccia noted in the wastewater plant effluent, PFOS was measured at 1.5 parts per trillion and PFOA was at 2.1 parts per trillion, both of which are well below allowed limits. He stated drinking water samples have been collected to establish a baseline. He noted this baseline could then be used in the future if PFAS contamination is ever discovered in our drinking water. He stated this is related to the nationwide PFAS lawsuit and we are trying to be on list if there is a phase two.

CONSENT AGENDA

2025-258 Approve consent agenda as presented.

Motion was made by Elenbaas and supported by Hopkins to approve the consent agenda as presented.

Motion unanimously approved.

PROCLAMATIONS

A. Family Court Awareness Month

Mayor Schippers read a proclamation declaring November 2025 as Family Court Awareness Month.

Tricia Winkler, Protective Parents of Michigan, discussed the need for judicial training on non-physical abuse and for expanding the AMBER Alert system.

PUBLIC HEARING

- A. Public hearing to consider adoption of Resolution to Approve Application to MSHDA Community Development Block Grant.

Theresa Waldo, Community Development Director, provided a presentation: City of Cadillac – MSHDA MI Neighborhood Program, Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Application (see attachment).

Mayor Schippers opened the public hearing.

There were no public comments.

Mayor Schippers closed the public hearing.

Elenbaas asked Owen Roberts, Director of Finance, to clarify that the \$400,000 has already been earmarked for this project.

Roberts noted as part of a bond issuance in 2020, there was a portion allocated to the public infrastructure improvements in that area. He stated part of the advantage, especially with this project, is not only could a vast majority of the project be covered by grant funds but then the loan can be paid back with captured dollars. He noted these funds have been on hand since 2020 and have grown to \$467,000 with interest earnings.

French asked if the City will retain ownership of the infrastructure.

Roberts stated it will be 100% public infrastructure.

2025-259 Approve Application to MSHDA CDBG.

Motion was made by Hopkins and supported by French to adopt the Resolution to Apply for the Community Development Block Grant Administered through the MSHDA MI Neighborhood Program, which includes the commitment of the matching funds of \$460,000, and authorizes Marcus Peccia, City Manager, to sign as the authorized official.

Motion unanimously approved.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

- A. Zoning Code Rewrite Advisory Committee

Peccia noted City Council previously approved moving forward with Progressive as our consultant to help us finish the Zoning Code rewrite. He stated we are forming a work group that is going to be meeting a few times over the next 6-8 months. He noted Council Member Engels stated that he is interested in being part of this committee.

2025-260 Appoint Council Member to serve on the Zoning Code Rewrite Advisory Committee.

Motion was made by Elenbaas and supported by French to appoint Council Member Engels to serve on the Zoning Code Rewrite Advisory Committee, which will tentatively meet four times in the next 6-8 months.

Motion unanimously approved.

B. Cadillac Commons Facilities Management Update

Peccia noted at the previous meeting there was a request from a Council Member for an update on the Cadillac Commons Facilities Management Plan.

Travis Owens, DDA Director & Main Street Program Manager, provided a Downtown Development Authority – Facilities Management Update (see attachment). He noted a draft reservation policy will be available to Council ahead of the meeting on November 17, 2025.

C. Recommendation regarding LDFA Well Residual Funds.

Roberts noted the LDFA has three accounting funds and one of those funds accounted for water sales to the power plant. He stated that well was built roughly the same time that the power plant was built and the LDFA started. He noted based on the years of that revenue being slightly ahead of the expenses, right now there is about \$430,000 in residual funds. He stated in working with our auditors, they said if we are closing an accounting fund we need governing body approval. He noted the LDFA unanimously approved the resolution to close the LDFA Utilities Fund and transfer those proceeds into another LDFA fund.

Roberts stated there are two other LDFA funds. He noted one is where the TIF captures go for the LDFA and the other fund accounts for the operations of the treatment process. He stated the proposal is to close that fund and transfer the proceeds to the same fund that the TIF proceeds go as long as that passes the auditor's test. He noted the phrasing of the motion that we requested is somewhat generic so it will enable us to close it into either of the other two funds. He stated there is \$430,000 in residual funds and those funds will help offset the groundwater treatment and all of the things that must be done on a regular basis. He noted that it's approximately a \$300,000 annual operating budget so those funds will help offset the cost of the Authority and will be spent accordingly.

French asked if it is up to the LDFA or the auditor to determine which account the proceeds will go to.

Roberts stated he recommended to the LDFA to have it closed into the same fund where the TIF capture dollars are deposited and held because those are more one-time bigger uses versus just sending it into the operating fund if it meets the test of the auditors. He noted the

LDFA supported that recommendation. He stated we looked at it legally as well, believe the funds belong to the LDFA and should continue to support their operations.

2025-261 Authorize closure of the LDFA Utilities Fund.

Motion was made by Elenbaas and supported by Hopkins to authorize closure of the LDFA Utilities Fund and transfer of all residual funds to another LDFA fund.

Motion unanimously approved.

D. Recommendation regarding support for free tote bags for Fire Department.

Peccia stated this item is a request for support regarding the acquisition of complimentary tote bags for the Fire Department that would be distributed at activities or events such as the Child Safety Expo. He noted the Fire Department logo will be on one side and the company will sell advertising space on the remaining three sides.

2025-262 Approve acquisition of free tote bags from the MARC Group.

Motion was made by Elenbaas and supported by French to approve the acquisition of free tote bags from the MARC Group at no cost to the City.

Motion unanimously approved.

E. First Presbyterian Church

Peccia stated the First Presbyterian Church is hosting a Craft and Vendor Sale on Saturday, November 15, 2025. He noted they are requesting approval for a sandwich board style sign to be placed in the right-of-way at the corner of N. Harris St. and Mitchell St. on the day of the event.

2025-263 Approve sign request from First Presbyterian Church.

Motion was made by Hopkins and supported by French to approve the temporary sign permit application from First Presbyterian Church as presented.

Motion unanimously approved.

ADOPTION OF ORDINANCES AND RESOLUTIONS

A. Adopt Resolution to Enter into Easement Agreement.

Peccia noted the City is requiring a public utility easement as a part of the Lakeland Apartments development on property owned by KMF Construction. He stated the easement will allow public utilities to be run through the property providing for a less environmental impact on the adjoining property. He noted the public utility infrastructure will be installed and paid for by the developer meeting all City specifications, with ownership granted to the City.

2025-264 Adopt Resolution to Enter into Easement Agreement.

Motion was made by Elenbaas and supported by French to adopt the resolution to enter a public utilities easement agreement.

Motion unanimously approved.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

There were no public comments.

GOOD OF THE ORDER

Peccia noted this evening Council approved the application for a Community Development Block Grant. He stated this is just one example of many over the years of how our City, starting with City Council and staff, is always looking for outside funding opportunities to help make things a reality that otherwise wouldn't be a reality. He noted we have asked for over \$28 million in 2025. He stated we will get some of it not all of it but it's an example of the amount of time, energy, and resources staff puts in knowing they have the support of City Council.

Mayor Schippers noted when we get those dollars, we have to use them for what the grant intended them to be used for so we can't use those dollars to fix the roads, for example.

Elenbaas thanked the Cadillac Area Visitors Bureau and everybody that was involved with our KISS weekend. He noted it was one of the best weekends Cadillac has seen in a long time. He stated there were people from all over Michigan as well as people from out of state in attendance.

French thanked all of the candidates running for City Council because it takes courage to put your name out there in this public forum. She encouraged people to exercise their privilege to vote by turning in their absentee ballots or by going to the polls.

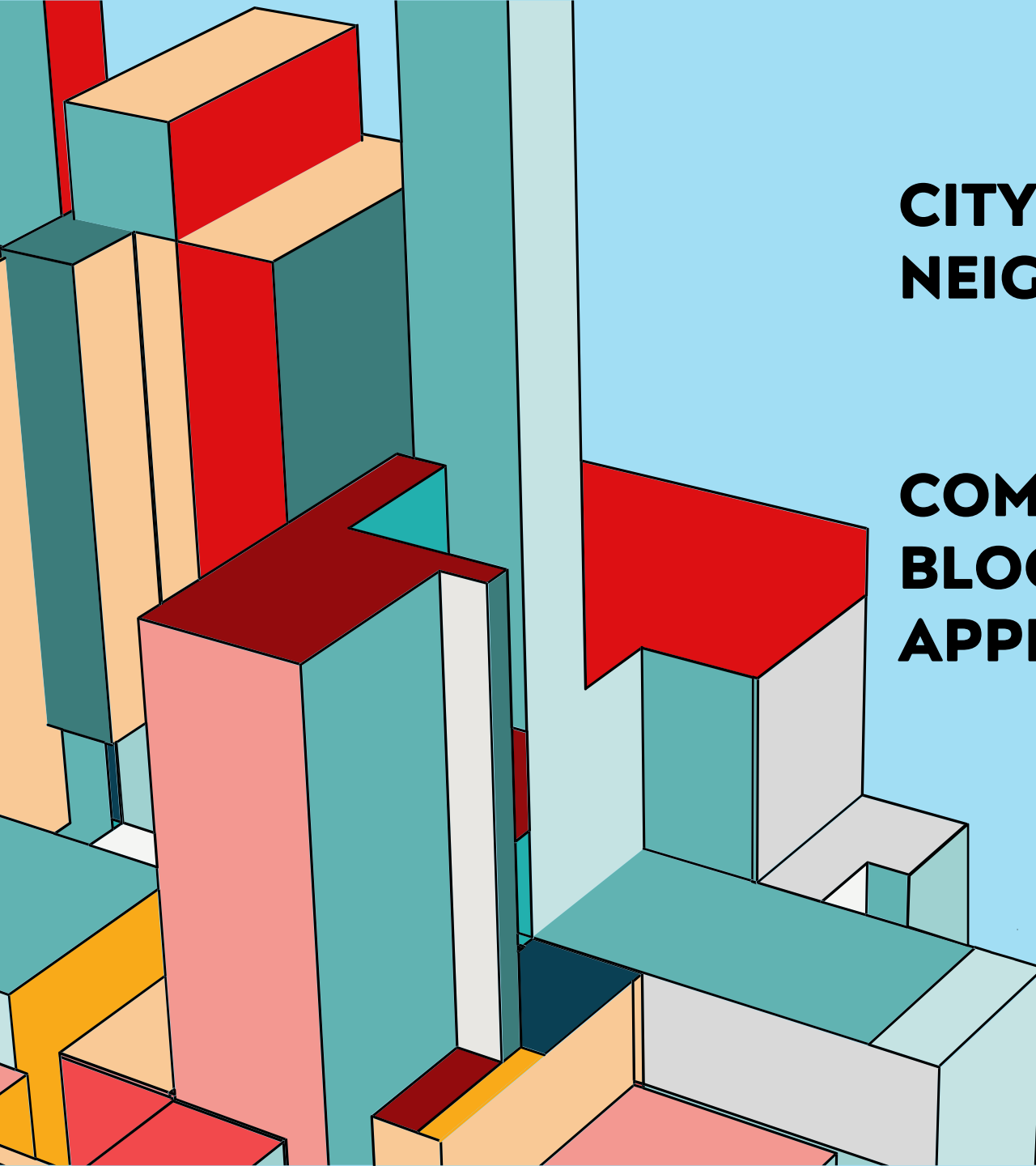
Mayor Schippers stated that yesterday a tour bus from Michigan State University came to town with the president of the university and fifty faculty members. She noted the new president of MSU is not from Michigan so this was a bus tour of Michigan with faculty members and Cadillac was the first stop. She stated the reason Cadillac was the first stop was because of all of the things they had been seeing in the news such as KISS and other things the Visitors Bureau is doing. She noted most of the people in attendance had never been to Cadillac and they could not stop gushing at how beautiful our community is and what a wonderful place it is.

ADJOURNMENT

Respectfully submitted,

Tiyi Schippers, Mayor

Sandra Wasson, City Clerk

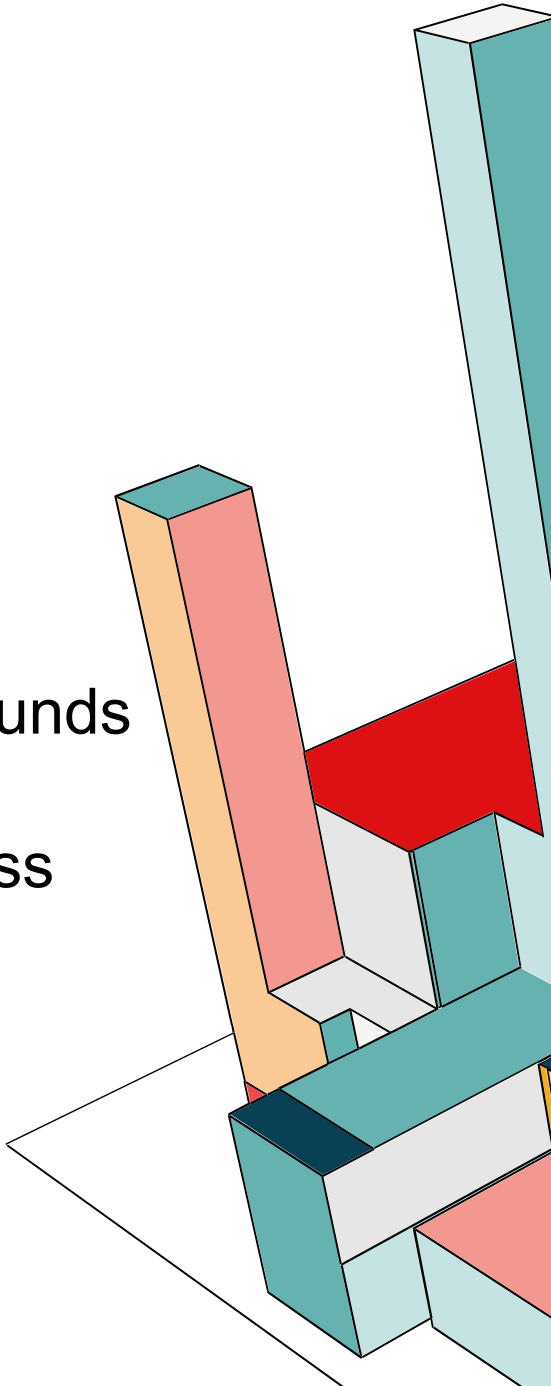
An abstract graphic on the left side of the slide consists of several 3D rectangular blocks of various colors (red, orange, teal, light blue, and white) stacked and arranged in a way that suggests a city skyline or a complex architectural structure. The blocks are rendered with black outlines and are set against a solid light blue background.

CITY OF CADILLAC – MSHDA MI NEIGHBORHOOD PROGRAM

COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT BLOCK GRANT (CDBG) APPLICATION

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

- MSHDA MI Neighborhood Program
- Invites Units of General Local Government to apply for CDBG funds
- Supports local infrastructure and housing needs
- Public Hearing and input is a requirement of the MSHDA process





PROJECT SUMMARY

- Cadillac requests \$873,200 in CDBG funds
- Public infrastructure upgrades: Chapin Street between Mitchell Street and Shelby Street
- Cadillac Lofts Phase 2 project will include approx. 52 units, 2,500 sq ft commercial
- Local match: Approx. \$460,000

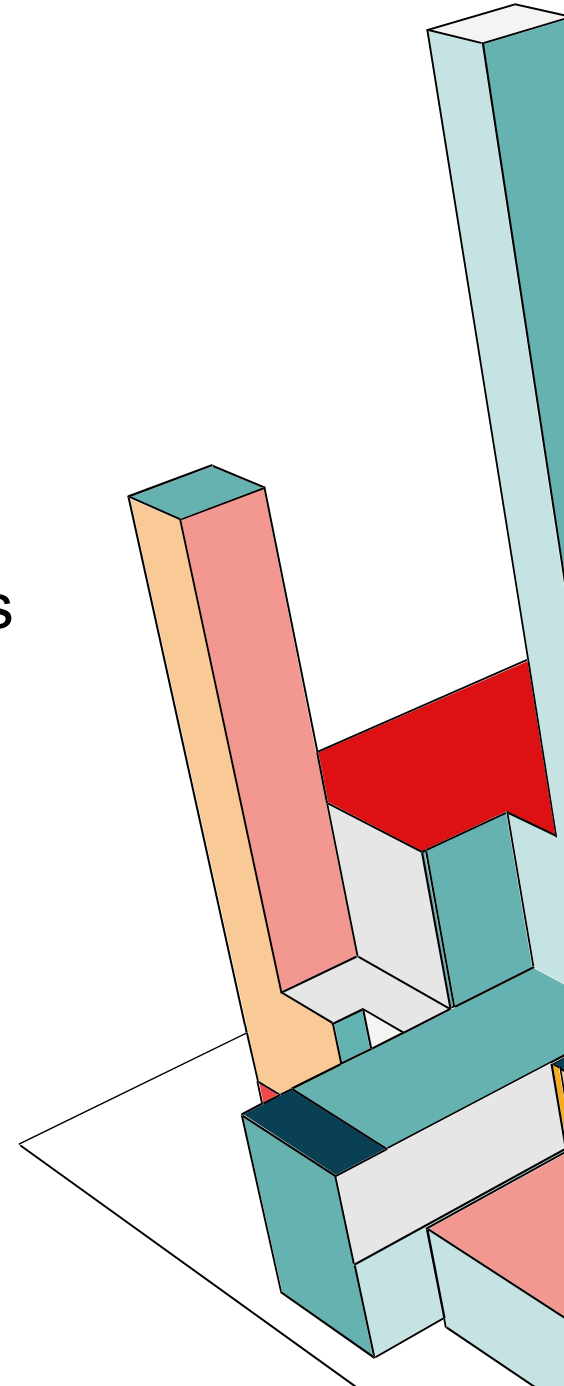


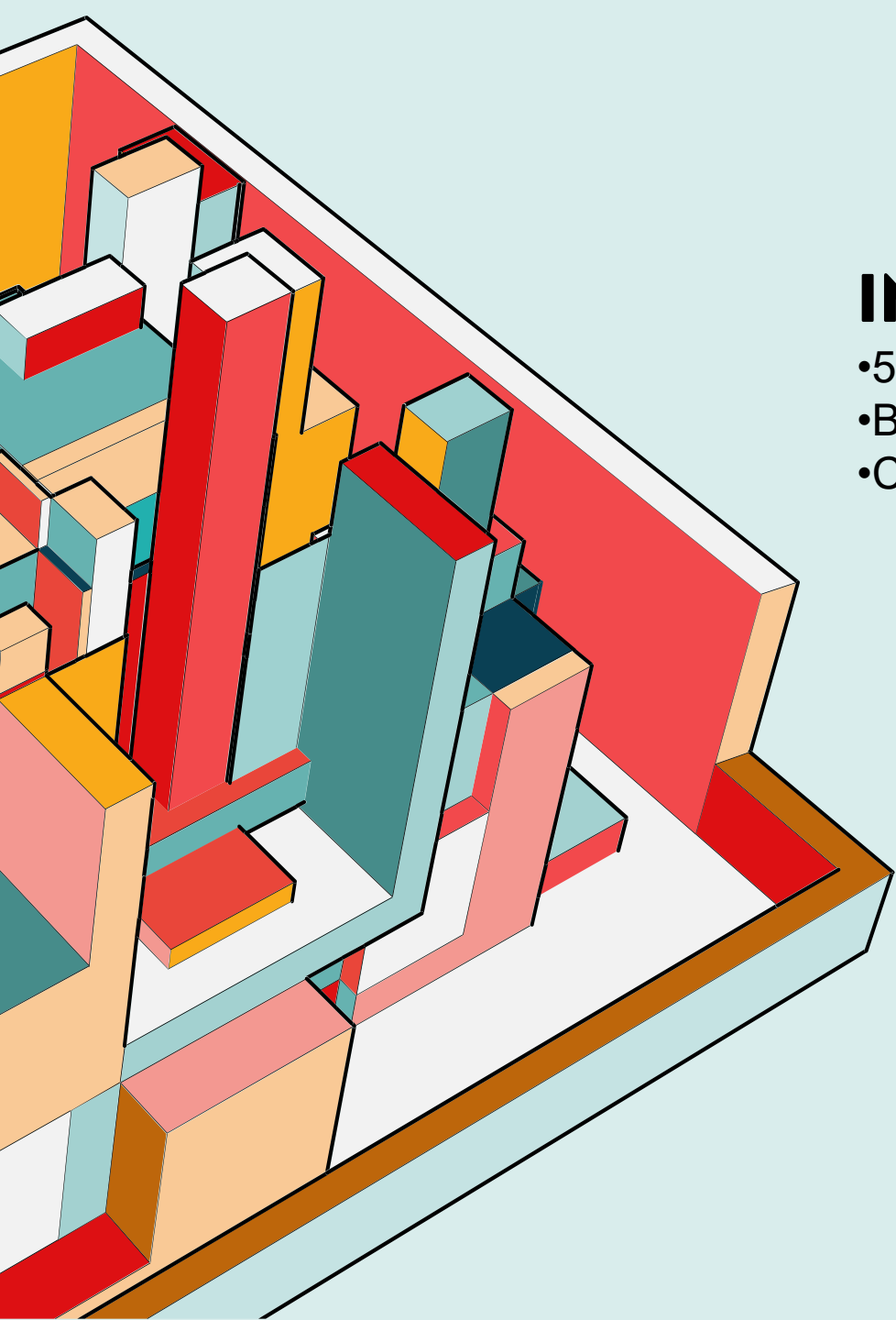
CADILLAC LOFTS PHASE 2

Chapin Street: Public parking, sidewalks, water, & sewer infrastructure

WHY INFRASTRUCTURE?

- CDBG-funded infrastructure improves neighborhood conditions and business density
- Supports community growth and resilience





IMPACT ON HOUSING AND ECONOMY

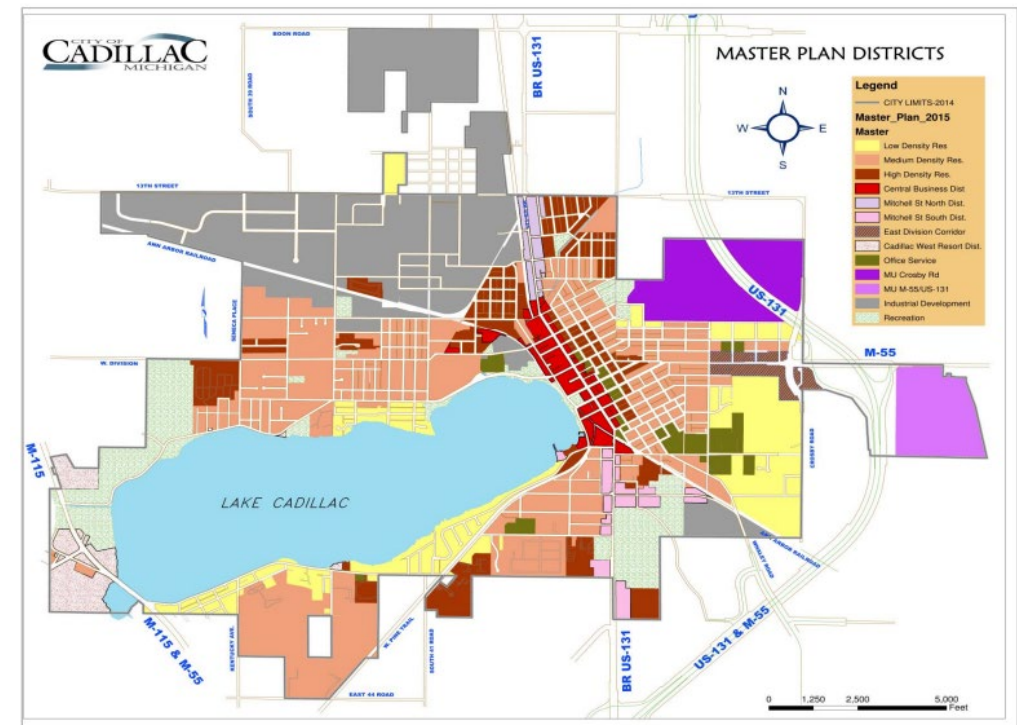
- 52 new apartment units, 2,500 sq ft commercial space
- Boosts affordable housing and local business
- CDBG infrastructure attracts additional investment

This project will deliver much-needed housing and create a vibrant new commercial space. Research shows that CDBG-supported infrastructure often leads to further public and private investment—setting off a virtuous cycle of growth and opportunity.

CADILLAC MASTER PLAN ALIGNMENT

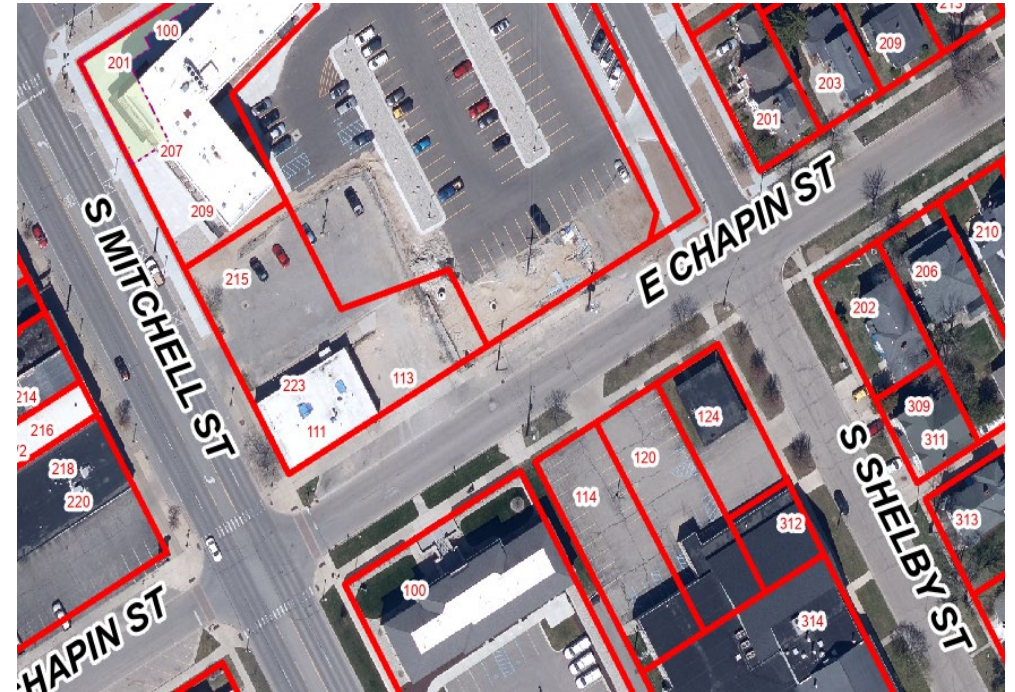
Cadillac Master Plan Alignment

- Consistent with Cadillac's Community Master Plan
- Prioritizes equity, sustainability, and compliance
- Meets MSHDA and HUD guidelines



EXPECTED OUTCOMES

1. New permanent, affordable housing
2. Improved public infrastructure, safety, and accessibility
3. New business opportunities and job creation
4. Higher property values, community well-being, and improved quality of life.



CONCLUSION

Cadillac's application leverages research-backed strategies

Strengthens infrastructure, housing, and the economy

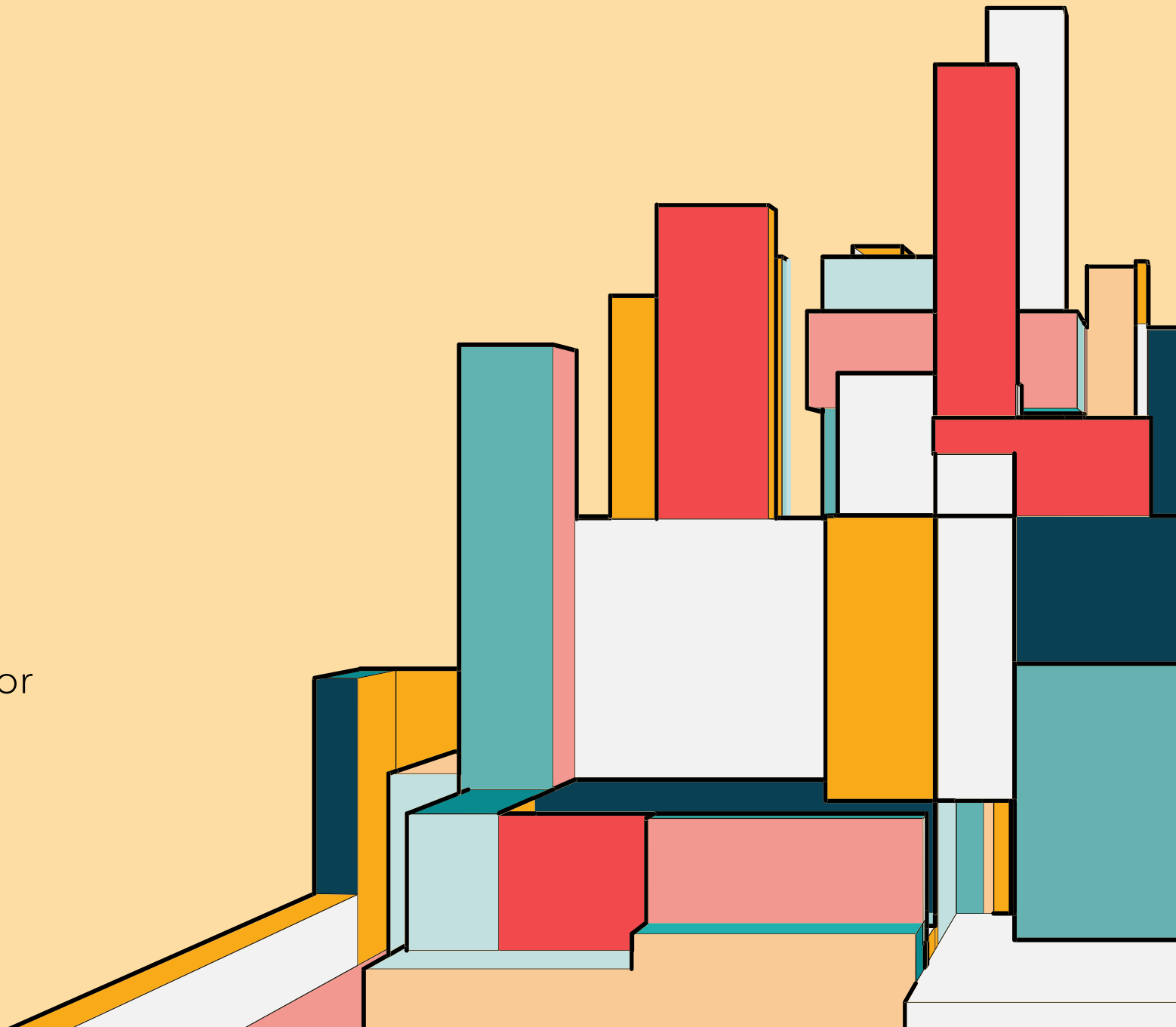
Long-term benefits for residents and businesses



THANK YOU

Theresa Waldo MM

Community Development Director



Downtown Development Authority – Facilities Management Update

Cadillac City Council – October 20, 2025

1. Overview

- The DDA is working closely with City staff to update the reservation policy for Cadillac Commons.
 - The DDA and the City are evaluating a partnership agreement for management of Cadillac Commons operations, under which the DDA would provide administrative support, oversee daily operations, and reimburse the City for maintenance support.
 - With the addition of a full-time Director, the DDA now has the capacity and experience to support the City of Cadillac by taking on this role.
 - To date, the DDA has invested over \$1 million in Cadillac Commons improvements, a clear sign of our long-term commitment to vibrant community space within the downtown district.
-

2. Clarification: Facilities vs. Events

- This update is about managing facilities, not hosting events.
 - The Cadillac Farmers Market is a recurring event run by a private organization that takes place inside The Market at Cadillac Commons, which is a building, not an event.
 - When we refer to “managing The Market,” we mean managing the building itself as a reservable event venue, not the events held there.
 - The new policy framework will eventually apply to all reservable spaces at Cadillac Commons, including:
 - The Market
 - White Pine Trailhead
 - Rotary Pavilion
 - The Plaza
 - City Park
 - Managing these spaces effectively has been a long-standing DDA goal, recognizing Cadillac Commons as a key community asset.
-

3. Financial Responsibility and Reinvestment

- By law, the DDA can only spend revenue on projects listed in its approved Tax Increment Financing (TIF) and Development Plan.
 - This means proceeds earned from managing Cadillac Commons will be reinvested directly into Downtown Cadillac.
 - These funds could support:
 - Parking lot repairs and upgrades
 - Streetscape beautification and new signage
 - Curb and gutter improvements
 - Rehabilitation of older commercial buildings
 - Marketing and business recruitment efforts
 - In short: every dollar stays downtown to make it a better place to live, work, and visit.
-

4. Existing Reservation Policy

- Current policies cannot adequately handle growing demand for event space.
 - A simple “first-come, first-served” system could create a rush of applications and equity concerns on January 1st each year.
 - The rates under the current reservation policy have not been updated since 2017 and are not consistent with the local market for event space.
 - Recent facility upgrades including overhead doors, restrooms, heating, and tables/chairs, have transformed The Market into a year-round, multi-use venue.
 - Intentional management and marketing are now essential to get the most value for the community.
 - The existing reservation policy does not cover the cost of cleaning, maintenance and/or administrative support of the Cadillac Commons facilities.
-

5. Reservation Policy Goals

- The new reservation policy is being created with the following goals in mind:
 - Improve scheduling and prevent conflicts.

- Prioritize community use by giving first access to community events, local nonprofits, and residents.
 - Maximize utilization to ensure public benefit.
 - Establish a transparent rate structure that reflects the quality of the facility and its amenities.
 - Protect access for designated Priority Events that are important to the community.
 - Incorporate best practices and successes from other Michigan communities.
-

6. Timeline and Next Steps

- Three key components are being developed together:
 - Reservation policy
 - Fee schedule
 - Operational structure
 - The goal is to finalize and implement the new reservation policy by January 1, 2026.
 - This timeline allows for input, refinement, and clear communication before changes take effect.
 - A draft reservation policy will be available to Council ahead of the meeting on Monday, November 17th.
-

7. Key Takeaway

- Cadillac Commons is an important community gathering place that reflects our city's identity.
- The DDA's goal is to manage The Cadillac Commons responsibly, equitably, and sustainably ensuring that every dollar earned goes back into Downtown Cadillac, supporting continued growth and community benefit.



ON BEHALF OF THE PEOPLE OF MICHIGAN,
I, Gretchen Whitmer, governor of Michigan, do hereby proclaim

December 8-14, 2025

as

WATER AND WASTEWATER PROFESSIONALS WORKFORCE WEEK

WHEREAS, water is one of our most valuable resources in Michigan and is necessary to sustain life; and,

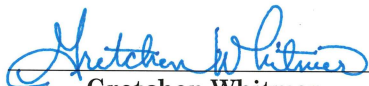
WHEREAS, a clean and abundant supply of water is important for the protection of public health for the citizens of Michigan; and,

WHEREAS, the drinking water and wastewater industry assists in the creation of jobs, attracts industry and investment, and provides safe recreational opportunities for Michigan residents; and,

WHEREAS, Michigan's certified drinking water and wastewater treatment workers focus on infrastructure, facilities, and services that are of vital importance to sustainable and resilient communities; and,

WHEREAS, the water and wastewater professionals' mission overall is to protect the public health, quality of life, and well-being of the people of Michigan;

NOW, THEREFORE, I, Gretchen Whitmer, governor of Michigan, do hereby proclaim December 8-14, 2025, as Water and Wastewater Professionals Workforce Week in Michigan.


Gretchen Whitmer
Governor



Minutes
Cadillac West Corridor Improvement Authority (CIA)
Regular Meeting
October 9, 2025

A regular meeting of the Cadillac West Corridor Improvement Authority (CIA) was held at City Hall at 3:30 pm on Thursday, October 9, 2025.

ROLL CALL

MEMBERS PRESENT: Hensley, Stange, Dewey, Host, Wickenhauser, Dietrich, Hopkins, Justice Walraven

MEMBERS ABSENT: Jake Walraven

STAFF PRESENT: Plugger, Waldo

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

- A. Motion to approve October 9, 2025, agenda by Wickenhauser, supported by Dewey.
 - a. The motion was approved unanimously.

MINUTES/REPORTS

- A. Motion to approve minutes from September 11, 2025, by Hensley, supported by Dietrich.
 - a. The motion was approved unanimously.

COMMITTEE REPORTS:

- A. Finance Report: Plugger updated that there was \$3.12 in interest on the latest report.

OLD BUSINESS:

- A. Hay Days Update: The festival was a success, hundreds of people attended touch a truck and the park was completely full. Dewey had supplied staff with a survey from the public and Plugger brought that up on the screen to show everyone, and told the board it would be shared with them after the meeting. Discussion took place about the event, and ideas to improve it next year. Several members stated the speed sign was very helpful and asked that staff find out more information about getting a permanent sign.
- B. Banner Pole update: Plugger updated that there is a formal process now to apply for a permit and there is a possibility to hang a guide-wire banner across the road. Staff will continue to pursue this.

NEW BUSINESS:

- A. Zoning Steering Committee Member: Plugger updated that Hensley had agreed to represent the authority and the Visitor's Bureau. Plugger shared that all meetings would be public and the board was welcome to attend.

COMMUNICATIONS/OTHER ITEMS

- A. Dewey shared the plans for the Christmas Tree Lighting even scheduled for Thanksgiving weekend, including adding more lighting to the mall.
- B. Dewey requested an update on improving the shared driveway by Walraven's. Staff stated the engineer was drafting numbers but would request an update for the next meeting.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

ADJOURNMENT: Motion was made to adjourn at 4:01 pm.